A Long Walk to Water

Session 2 — Alone, Then Moving Forward

LEARNING GOAL

The student can explain how Salva responds to being left alone, compare Nya’s daily burden with Salva’s journey, and use at least two new vocabulary words.

Session Date: _____ · Chapters 3–4

RECAP

Two Timelines, New Pressure

2008 — **NYA**

Reaches the muddy pond, carries water home, then begins a second trip.

1985 — **SALVA**

Wakes alone, receives brief help, then joins a new group of travelers.

Focus: survival becomes a routine for both characters—but in very different ways.

ROADMAP

Today's Session, Start to Finish

1

~5 min

Warm-Up

What does it mean to be left behind?

2

~15 min

Read

Four key passages from Chapters 3–4.

3

~10 min

Solve

Discuss choices, identity, and survival.

4

~10 min

Memorize

Learn five high-value vocabulary words.

5

~10 min

Test

Vocabulary + comprehension check.

6

~5 min

Wrap-Up

Short writing and exit ticket.

1 · WARM-UP

Opening Conversation

~5 min

“If a group thought you might slow them down, what could you do to prove that you belong?”

Today you will:

Read four scenes, discuss how Salva earns a place in a group, compare his struggle with Nya’s routine, and learn new words.

TIP
Ask for a specific action, not just “try harder.”

Nya Reaches the Pond

SCENE — Southern Sudan, 2008 · Chapter Three

PDF pp. 17–18

Nya reaches the muddy pond, drinks, fills the container, balances it on her head, and starts the harder walk home.

While reading, ask:

What details show that getting water is physically demanding?

Salva Meets the Dinka Woman

SCENE — Southern Sudan, 1985 · Chapter Three

PDF pp. 18–19

Salva recognizes the woman’s Dinka scar patterns. She gives him peanuts, but cannot tell him how to find his family.

While reading, ask:

Why does recognizing the Dinka markings immediately change Salva’s feelings?

The Woman Must Leave

SCENE — Southern Sudan, 1985 · Chapter Three

PDF pp. 20–21

The pond is drying up, fighting is nearby, and the old woman tells Salva he cannot travel with her. Then Salva hears approaching voices.

While reading, ask:

Why is the woman’s decision understandable even though it hurts Salva?

A New Group & the Long Walk

SCENE — Southern Sudan, 1985 · Chapter Four

PDF pp. 22–25

A Dinka group agrees to take Salva. He is determined not to lag behind. Hunger grows until Buksa follows a honey guide to a beehive.

While reading, ask:

What does Salva do to make himself useful—or at least not a burden—to the group?

3 · SOLVE

From Reading to Interpretation

1 Why does Salva feel relief when he sees the old woman’s Dinka scar patterns?

2 How does Nya’s trip home differ from her trip to the pond?

3 Why do some travelers initially resist taking Salva with them?

4 What does Salva’s decision not to complain reveal about his character?

5 How do Chapters 3–4 develop the idea of belonging?

Teacher follow-up: “What in the text makes you think that?” Have the student point to a specific detail.

4 · MEMORIZE

New Words: Part 1

R

Ritual

a formal or traditional practice

PRACTICE Why are the scar patterns meaningful to Salva?

U

Uncertainty

the state of not knowing what will happen

PRACTICE What uncertainty is Salva facing?

A

Artillery

large military weapons used to fire shells

PRACTICE How does distant artillery affect Salva?

4 · MEMORIZE

New Words: Part 2

D

Determined firmly decided to do something

PRACTICE How is Salva determined not to become a burden?

T

Terrain the physical features of an area of land

PRACTICE How does the terrain change during the journey?

5 · TEST

Quick Check

PART A — Vocabulary

1. Ritual means — (a) traditional practice (b) accident (c) argument
2. Uncertainty means — (a) confidence (b) not knowing (c) hunger
3. Determined means — (a) firmly decided (b) confused (c) weak

PART B — Fill in the blank

4. The distant sound of _____ reminded Salva that the fighting was still nearby.
5. The _____ changed from scrub to woodland.

PART C — Short Answer

6. Why does the old woman refuse to let Salva travel with her?
7. Why does the Dinka group finally agree to take Salva?
8. What does Buksa’s discovery of the beehive show about survival skills?

6 · WRAP-UP

Short Writing

~5 min

How does Salva begin to change after he is left alone?

1 Salva begins to change because _____.

2 One important example is _____.

3 This shows that he is becoming more _____.

Exit Ticket

Describe one challenge faced by Nya and one challenge faced by Salva. Use one new vocabulary word in your answer.

HOMEWORK

- Read Chapter 5
- Write three original sentences using today’s vocabulary
- Bring one question about Salva’s journey or Nya’s water routine

SEE YOU NEXT SESSION

Chapter 5 — Hunger, Honey, and Survival

Bring your three sentences and your discussion question.